Impressions up 18%. Clicks up 6%.

For anyone writing a monthly SEO report for a client or a boss.

THE SAMPLE MONTH

2.7%

CTR fell from 3.0% to 2.7%

One sample month from our SEO report guide.

THE MATH

Clicks grew at a third of the rate

CTR is clicks divided by impressions, so it had to fall.

IN PLAIN TERMS

Seen more often, picked less often

That can be fine or a problem. The 18% alone will not tell you which.

THE TRAP

Accurate and still misleading

A summary that opens with 18% and buries CTR in a table further down.

HOW WE READ IT

Impressions and clicks go side by side

Never report one without the other.

BEFORE THE MEETING

Work out the CTR yourself

So the drop is not news to you when the client asks.

ORDER AND ACTION

Lead with the number that draws questions

Under every metric, write what you will do about it.

YOUR MOVE

Rewrite this month's opening line

Start with the line most likely to get a question, then the action.

